Lindsey (Lanxin) Ma

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Dear Descript Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Applied Research Scientist role on your AI Research team. I hold an M.S. in Statistics from Columbia University (May 2026), and the focus on multimodal understanding, measurable evaluation, and models that ship is the work I want to do.

Evaluation is where I have spent the most care. At Arborphy AI I built a plant species classifier with an EfficientNet–BioCLIP dual-encoder and bidirectional spatial cross-attention, and designed a leakage-aware evaluation protocol with individual-disjoint splits, multi-seed runs and grouped held-out sets. It showed that an apparent gain from fusion did not reliably beat a BioCLIP-only baseline, which changed what we built next. I also benchmarked frozen BioCLIP, DINOv3 and EfficientNet embeddings with linear probes and cross-species retrieval.

I have worked with video and with building the data a method needs. At the InnoX Academy robotics lab I built a real-time vision pipeline at 20+ FPS with detection, pose estimation and tracking. As a Research Assistant at Columbia I trained ResNet and U-Net denoisers for two-photon calcium imaging videos and built synthetic benchmark datasets with known ground truth, so reconstruction quality could be measured rather than guessed. I also built interpretability tooling across all 28 layers of a transformer language model.

Making editorial quality measurable, and training specialized models that let an editing agent perceive the media it works on, is a problem I would be glad to work on. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Lindsey Ma